

Who are Masons and what do they do?

Men of Character and Integrity Join the Masons

Most are men who go about their jobs and professions with no hint they are Freemasons except for the way they lead their lives. Many are readily recognizable by name, face, or accomplishment. George Washington and thirteen other Presidents, eight Vice Presidents and forty-two Justices of the Supreme Court have been Masons.

Some Notable Masons

Eddy Arnold	Benjamin Franklin	William McKinley
Roy Acuff	Clark Gable	Lauritz Melchior
Edwin "Buzz" Aldrin*	Benjamin Galman*	James Monroe
Gene Autry	John Glenn	Wolfgang A. Mozart*
L. Van Beethoven	Arthur Godfrey	Arnold Palmer*
Irving Berlin	Barry Goldwater	Dr. Norman V. Peale*
Simon Bolivar	John Hancock	J.C. Penney
Gutzon Borglum	Harry Hershfield	John Pershing
Ernest Borgnine	Harry Houdini	Eddie Rickenbacker
Omar Bradley	Sam Houston	Branch Rickey
Richard E. Byrd	Hubert H. Humphrey	Will Rogers
DeWitt Clinton	Burl Ives	Theodore Roosevelt
Ty Cobb	Andrew Jackson	Franklin D. Roosevelt
George M. Cohan	Al Jolson	David Sarnoff
Davy Crockett	John Paul Jones	Jean Sibelius
Norm Crosby	Jack Kemp	Red Skelton
Cecil B. deMille	Rudyard Kipling	John Philip Sousa*
Jack Dempsey	Marquis de Lafayette	Danry Thomas
John Diefenbaker*	Fiorello LaGuardia	Dave Thomas*
Jimmy Doolittle	Charles A. Lindbergh	Lowell Thomas
Duke Ellington	Douglas MacArthur*	Harry S. Truman*
Sir Alexander Fleming	George C. Marshall	George Washington*
Gerald R. Ford*	Thurgood Marshall	Thomas J. Watson
Henry Ford	Charles W. Mayo	John Wayne

*Illustrated on foldout page



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Who Are The Masons

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And What Do They Do?

Freemasons, Some of the Greatest of Men...



...and Men from All Walks of Life

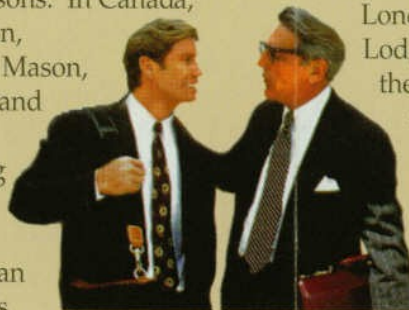
ACCOUNTANTS • COOKS • ARCHITECTS
CABINETMAKERS • DENTISTS • ACTORS
• DOCTORS • ACTUARIES • ADJUSTERS
GRAPHIC DESIGNERS • BUSINESSMEN •
• ADVERTISING EXECUTIVES • GUARDS
AIRLINE PILOTS • FUNERAL DIRECTORS
• CALLIGRAPHERS • CHIROPRACTORS •
FINANCIERS • DRUGGISTS • BUTCHERS
METALLURGISTS • BAKERS • NEWSMEN
• MILITARY OFFICERS • BOOKKEEPERS
CATERERS • BUILDERS • COMPOSERS •
MERCHANDISERS • EDITORS • ARTISTS
• PAINTERS • AUTOMOBILE SALESMEN
• FARMERS • EDUCATORS • ENGINEERS
APPRAISERS • ELECTRICIANS • BOXERS
PHYSICIANS • ATTORNEYS • BANKERS •
• DRY CLEANERS • CHEMISTS • MASONS
JEWELERS • LOCKSMITHS • FISHERMEN
RESEARCH SCIENTISTS • CONSULTANTS
• VETERINARIANS • PHILANTHROPISTS
ASSAYERS • COMEDIANS • GARDENERS
INDUSTRIALISTS • GLAZIERS • MIMES •
FURRIERS • MECHANICS • MACHINISTS
ORTHODONTISTS • MANUFACTURERS •
• CONTRACTORS • RESTAURANTEURS
CHEFS • LIBRARIANS • DECORATORS •
FLORISTS • EXECUTIVES • INVENTORS
CLERKS • ENGRAVERS • CONDUCTORS
• PHARMACISTS • ANTHROPOLOGISTS
NUCLEAR PHYSICISTS • GEOGRAPHERS
SUPREME COURT JUSTICES • GOLF PROS
• LANDSCAPE ARCHITECTS • MODELS •
OPTICIANS • MUSICIANS • ORGANISTS
• INVESTMENT COUNSELORS • SINGERS
GOLDSMITHS • GUIDANCE COUNSELORS
• PHYSICAL THERAPISTS • POLICEMEN
• TEACHERS • TAILORS • CARPENTERS •
GEOGRAPHERS • MANAGERS • JUDGES
• PHOTOGRAPHERS • HABERDASHERS •
MAGAZINE PUBLISHERS • ASTRONAUTS
PRESIDENTS • AUTHORS • ECOLOGISTS
SENATORS • MAILERS • CONGRESSMEN
LUMBERJACKS • PLUMBERS • MILLERS

Who Are The Masons?

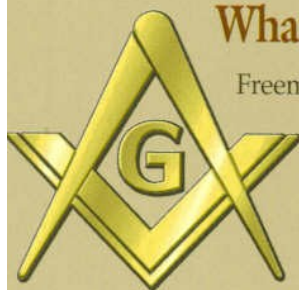
Masons (also known as Freemasons) belong to the oldest and largest fraternal organization in the world. Today, there are more than two million Freemasons in North America. Masons represent virtually every occupation and profession, yet within the Fraternity, all meet as equals. Masons come from diverse political ideologies, yet meet as friends. Masons come from varied religious beliefs and creeds, yet all believe in one God.

Many of North America's early patriots were Freemasons. Thirteen signers of the Constitution and fourteen Presidents of the United States, including George Washington, were Masons. In Canada, the Father of the Confederation, Sir John A. MacDonald, was a Mason, as were other early Canadian and American leaders.

One of the most fascinating aspects of Freemasonry is how so many men, from so many different walks of life, can meet together in peace, always conducting their affairs in harmony and friendship and calling each other "Brother."



What Is Freemasonry?



Freemasonry (or Masonry) is dedicated to the *Brotherhood of Man under the Fatherhood of God*. It uses the tools and implements of ancient architectural craftsmen symbolically in a system of instruction designed to build character and moral values in its members. Its singular purpose is to make good men better. Its bonds of friendship, compassion, and brotherly love have survived even the most divisive political, military, and religious

conflicts through the centuries. Freemasonry is a fraternity which encourages its members to practice the faith of their personal acceptance. Masonry teaches that each person, through self-improvement and helping others, has an obligation to make a difference for good in the world.

Where Did Freemasonry Begin?

No one knows just how old Freemasonry is because the actual origins have been lost in time. Most scholars believe Masonry rose from the guilds of stonemasons who built the majestic castles and cathedrals of the middle ages. In 1717, Masonry created a formal organization when four Lodges in London joined in forming England's first Grand Lodge. By 1731, when Benjamin Franklin joined the Fraternity, there were already several Lodges in the Colonies, and in Canada the first Lodge was established in 1738.

Today, Masonic Lodges are found in almost every community throughout North America, and in large cities there are usually several Lodges.

A Mason can travel to almost any country in the world and find a Masonic Lodge where he will be welcomed as a "Brother."

What Do Freemasons Do?

The Masonic experience encourages members to become better men, better husbands, better fathers, and better citizens. The fraternal bonds formed in the Lodge help build lifelong friendships among men with similar goals and values.

Beyond its focus on individual development and growth, Masonry is deeply involved in helping people. The Freemasons of North America contribute over two million dollars a day to charitable causes. This philanthropy represents an unparalleled example of the humanitarian commitment



of this great and honorable Fraternity. Much of that assistance goes to people who are not Masons. Some of these charities are vast projects. The Shrine Masons (Shriners) operate the largest network of hospitals for burned and orthopaedically impaired children in the country, and there is never a fee for treatment. The Scottish Rite Masons maintain a nationwide network of over 150 Childhood Language Disorder Clinics, Centers, and Programs.

Many other Masonic organizations sponsor a variety of philanthropies, including scholarship programs

for students, and perform public service activities in their communities. Masons also enjoy the fellowship of each other and their families in social and recreational activities.



Several Masonic Principles Are:

- Faith must be the center of our lives.
- All men and women are the children of God.
- No one has the right to tell another person what he or she must think or believe.
- Each person has a responsibility to be a good citizen, obeying the law.
- It is important to work to make the world a better place for all.
- Honor and integrity are keys to a meaningful life.

What Is The Masonic Lodge?

The word "Lodge" means both a group of Masons meeting together as well as the room or building in which they meet. Masonic buildings are sometimes called "temples" because the original meaning of the term was "place of knowledge" and Masonry encourages the advancement of knowledge.

Masonic Lodges usually meet once or twice a month to conduct regular business, vote upon petitions for membership, and bring new Masons into the Fraternity through three ceremonies called degrees. In the Lodge room Masons share in a variety of programs. Here the bonds of friendship and fellowship are formed and strengthened.



Who Can Qualify To Join?

Applicants must be men of good character who believe in a Supreme Being. To become a Mason one must petition a particular Lodge. The Master of the Lodge appoints a committee to visit the applicant prior to the Lodge balloting upon his petition.

So Who Are The Masons?

Masons are men of good character who strive to improve themselves and make the world a better place. They belong to the oldest and most honorable fraternity known to man. If you think you may be interested in becoming a member, you can begin by contacting a Lodge in your area or speaking to a Mason.

